

All configuration keys and their scope

File hierarchy

```
~/ .claude/settings.json      (global, all projects)
  ↓ overridden by
. claude/settings.json       (project, shared with team)
  ↓ overridden by
. claude/settings.local.json  (local machine, gitignore)
```

Project-local settings override project and user settings. CLI arguments and managed policy have higher priority. Use local settings for personal overrides without Git conflicts.

Complete structure

```
{
  "model": "claude-sonnet-5-5",
  "permissions": {
    "allow": ["Bash(git *)", "Bash(pnpm *)",
"Read"],
    "deny": ["Bash(rm -rf *)", "Write(*.env*)"],
    "ask":  ["Bash(npm publish)"],
    "defaultMode": "acceptEdits",
    "additionalDirectories": ["../shared-libs/"]
  },
  "env": {
    "NODE_ENV": "development",
    "LOG_LEVEL": "debug"
  },
  "statusLine": {
    "type": "command",
    "command": "~/ .claude/statusline.sh"
  },
  "outputStyle": "Explanatory",
  "hooks": {
    "PostToolUse": [{
      "matcher": "Edit|Write",
      "hooks": [{ "type": "command",
"command": ".claude/hooks/
format.sh" }]
    }]
  }
}
```

Available keys

Key	Role
<code>model</code>	Default model
<code>permissions.allow</code>	Auto-approved tools
<code>permissions.deny</code>	Blocked tools
<code>permissions.ask</code>	Tools requiring confirmation
<code>permissions.defaultMode</code>	Default mode (default/acceptEdits/plan/auto/dontAsk/bypassPermissions)
<code>permissions</code> → <code>additionalDirectories</code>	Additional accessible directories
<code>env</code>	Injected environment variables
<code>hooks</code>	Scripts triggered on events
<code>statusLine</code>	Custom status line
<code>outputStyle</code>	Communication style (Default/Proactive/Concise/Explanatory/Learning)

Key	Role
<code>spinnerVerbs</code>	Words in the loading spinner
<code>spinnerTipsOverride</code>	Tips displayed during processing
<code>enableAllProjectMcpServers</code>	Enables all project MCP servers

Spinner customization

```
{
  "spinnerVerbs": {
    "mode": "replace",
    "verbs": ["Caffeinating...", "Thinking...",
"Optimizing..."]
  },
  "spinnerTipsOverride": {
    "tips": ["/compact when context is full"],
    "excludeDefault": true
  }
}
```

`mode: "append"` extends the default list rather than replacing it. These keys have no functional impact, only cosmetic.

What should stay in .gitignore

```
.claude/settings.local.json  # Local machine overrides
CLAUDE.local.md             # Personal project instructions
.env.local                  # Secrets
```

Files to commit (`settings.json` , `agents/` , `skills/` , `hooks/` , `rules/`) represent the shared team configuration. Never include API keys or tokens in these files.